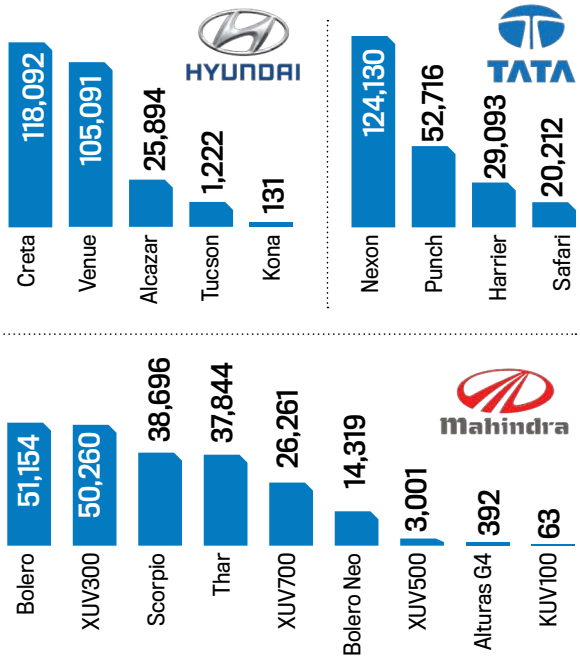
Top 10 SUV makers and their models

(Sales in 2021-22)



Source: JATO Dynamics

RENAULT KIGER
₹5.45 LAKH



Carmakers are using the same platform that they used for hatchbacks to make SUVs. Manufacturers do not want to miss a trend, but in the long term, that could lead to oversaturation of the segment. "The Indian market is now no more a small car market. Utility vehicles have overtaken the hatchback segment," says Gaurav Vangaal, associate director, Light Vehicle Production Forecast, S&P Global Mobility. "The good road presence, better quality ride and increased aspiration to own an SUV have contributed to robust sales of SUVs."

PUSH FROM CARMAKERS

Carmakers are planning more launches in the SUV segment to capitalise on the rising demand. Tata Motors, which has SUVs such as the Nexon, Punch, Harrier and Safari in its portfolio, is reportedly planning to launch six new SUVs, and is working on a premium crossover or compact SUV to compete with the likes of the Hyundai Creta and Kia Seltos. Maruti Suzuki, which has the Brezza and the recently showcased Grand Vitara in its SUV portfolio, is planning a special focus on this segment. After discontinuing the S-Cross in July, it recently launched the New Brezza, both manual and automatic. On August 15, Mahindra & Mahindra, which already has SUV brands such as the Bolero, XUV300, Thar, Scorpio, Alturas, and XUV700, unveiled its plans for five electric SUVs, expected to go on sale by end-2024. "Today, with the government support, rapid lowering of the cost of ownership and increased environmental awareness, it's the right time to enter the market with our range of battery EVs," says Anand Mahindra, chairman of the Mahindra Group. South Korean carmaker Kia Motors, which already sells its SUVs Seltos and Sonet in India, is said to have started work on developing an electric SUV, expected to hit the roads in 2025.

Meanwhile, overall passenger car sales in July 2022 stood at 341,302 units, up 17.10 per cent when compared to 291,464 units sold in July 2021. The trend in favour of SUVs is likely to continue for some time. As long as it does, automakers will make hay, offering more and more features and launching newer models. Coming out of the pandemic, the buzz around the SUV segment is also likely to keep the auto sector buoyant. Much hope is pegged on the upcoming festive season, where carmakers are looking forward to record sales. The improvement in the semiconductor supply has added to this optimism, though high interest rates on auto loans could turn out to be a spoilsport. ■

MAHINDRA BOLERO
₹8.40 LAKH

